6.2.2 8-bit data

8-bit data is user defined; however, if it is character data, it is in UTF-8. Each 8-bit unit is transmitted with the *b1* "first", up to *b8* "last". (NOTE: at a lower protocol level: in 16-QAM 4 bits are sent in parallel, 64-QAM: 6 bits in parallel, 256-QAM: 8 bits in parallel, 1024-QAM: 10 bits in parallel.)

- Pad character: CR (0x0D in 8 bits, after bits reversal) in the case of characters (UTF-8).
  Otherwise: the pad octet is user defined.
- Character table (if characters): ISO/IEC 10646 [10]; UTF-8, 1 to 4 octets per character

Deprecated for all use as character set except for UTF-8 (ISO/IEC 10646 [10]). The UTF-8 text should be in NFC (Normal Form C) (Unicode). For UTF-8, the mappings in subclause 6.2.3 apply when sending as well as receiving an SMS message.

When splitting a message text into submessages (using UTF-8), there must be no cut inside of a UTF-8 byte sequence. When not used for characters, the split rule, if any, is user defined.